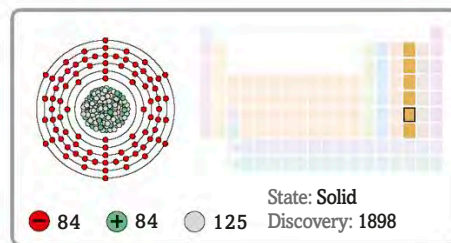


84

Po

Polonium



Forms

This uranium ore contains **0.0000001 per cent** polonium.

This mineral contains uranium atoms that break apart to form atoms of polonium.

Uraninite



Uses



Anti-static brush

This brush is used to remove static electric charge from camera lenses and music records.

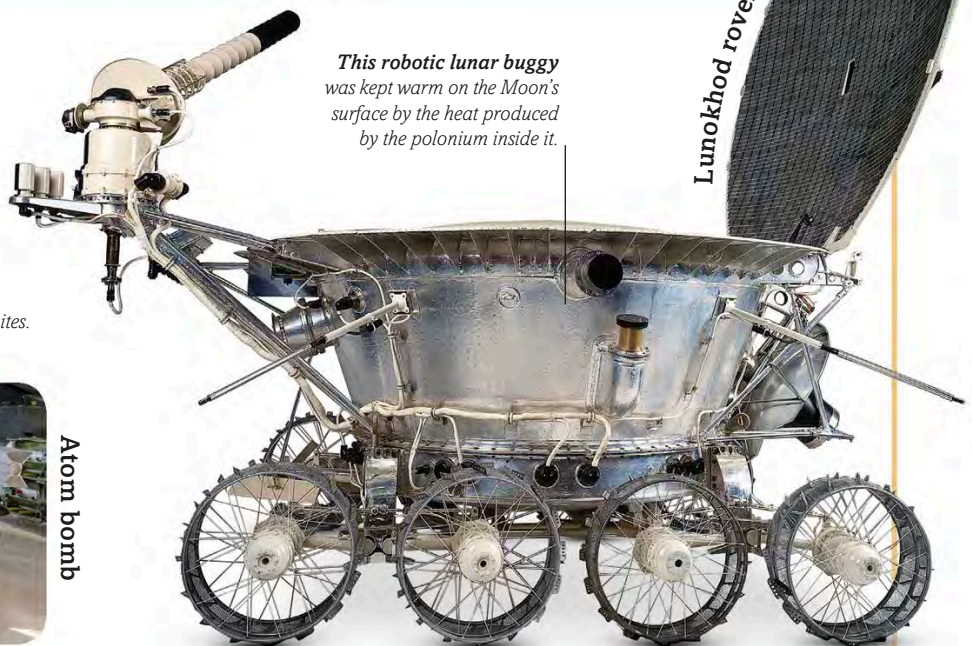
This bomb can be detonated when the polonium inside it ignites.



Atom bomb

This robotic lunar buggy was kept warm on the Moon's surface by the heat produced by the polonium inside it.

Lunokhod rover



Polonium is very radioactive: 1 g (0.03 oz) of this metal quickly heats up to 500°C (932°F) because of the radiation it emits.

This element was discovered by Marie and Pierre Curie in 1898. Marie named it after Poland, her homeland. It is rare in nature,

and is normally produced in nuclear reactors. Despite its radioactivity, this element is used in a few ways. It can trigger the explosion of **atom bombs**. It heats and powers spacecraft, such as the Russian **Lunokhod rovers**, which landed on the Moon in the 1970s.